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Follett Software

Senior Director, Software Development

Target Role: Senior Director, Software Development **Lead Record:** [wwwworkremote` Lead #126] (http://localhost:31000/admin/leads/126) / [Posting #5624](http://localhost:31000/api/v0/job_postings/5624)

Company Profile: Follett Software (Chicago, IL / Remote — K–12 Education Technology, Destiny Library Platform) **Tone Calibration:** Understated, zero-fluff, honest level assessment. --- ## 1. Role Scope & Stack Analysis

Scope: Executive engineering director leading multiple product lines (Destiny Library Manager, Resource Manager, Accessit Library). Manages Development Managers and Senior Engineers.

Core Technical Mandate: Legacy modernization (Java, J2EE, .NET, JBoss, WildFly, SQL Server, jQuery → Azure cloud microservices), back-to-school peak load reliability, Spec-Driven Development, and AI workflow adoption.

Management Burden: Direct people management, performance coaching, succession planning, recruiting, and budget ownership across multiple product managers/teams. --- ## 2. Fit & Level Calibration (Skeptical Peer Lens)

Dimension	Target Role Expectation	Mike's Grounded Signal	Fit Status
Technical Mandate	Modernize legacy Java/J2EE/.NET monoliths to cloud; establish Spec-Driven workflows & telemetry. Led OneMain Acquisition lane modernization, OpenTelemetry enterprise rollout across 36+ services, and 90-day EMR-Bear legacy audit.	Strong Match	Operational Peak
Operational Peak	Ensure 100% uptime during high-stakes back-to-school enrollment peak. Handled peak loan acquisition load; reduced system-wide MTTR by 60% via real-time tracing.	Strong Match	Role Track
Role Track	Executive People Director (managing managers, HR reviews, budget tracking). Principal Software Engineer / Staff Architect (Technical IC leadership; OneMain Associate Director was an IC corporate grade with no direct reports).	Track Mismatch	Work Environment
Work Environment	Heavy synchronous management & cross-departmental administrative meetings. High-autonomy Principal IC track with async RFC/ADR documentation focus.	Potential Friction	

--- ## 3. Strategic Recommendation

Primary Recommendation: De-prioritize for IC Target Roles. If your job search priority is a Principal IC / System Architect role with deep technical ownership and low management administrative overhead, this Senior Director post is a structural mismatch.

Alternative Pitch (If Pursuing as Chief Architect / Principal): If Follett is attractive as a Chicago/Remote EdTech target, do not position as a people-manager. Pitch as a **Principal Software Engineer / Chief Architect** who will partner with their

Director of Engineering to execute the multi-product legacy modernization (Java/J2EE -> microservices), enforce Spec-Driven Development standards, and safeguard back-to-school reliability.

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